

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Firsts Fund is a proposed peso UITF that helps early-career Filipinos invest for the big “firsts” that are five or more years away: the first trip abroad with their parents, a first car, a first home, a first business. From **₱100**, it owns shares of companies around the world that run the essential, hard-to-replace systems everyday life depends on: power grids, water, digital networks, ports, airports, hospitals, and the equipment behind them. One fee, held directly, chosen by published rules.

₱100 to start and per top-up	31 companies in 14 markets	1.50% a year, one fee layer (proposed)	5+ years recommended horizon	25.0% a year, holdings (hindsight) · NFRA 10.0%
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The problem

A young Filipino earns, saves and spends in pesos, so almost everything they own already depends on one economy. The products that are easy to start with are mostly savings or money-market funds, which suit short goals but are unlikely to grow enough for a goal five or more years away. Global equity is usually reached through feeder funds that add a second layer of fees, often with a ₱1,000 minimum.

Our answer

Name the goal, not the product. The investor starts with a “first” and a date; the app turns it into a monthly amount; the money goes into one global equity fund built for long horizons. When the date gets close, an optional goal service (proposed) gradually moves part of that investor’s units to a lower-risk fund. Then they set their next first.

What the fund owns

Listed businesses that own, operate or supply essential capacity and earn from it, in eight kinds: power and grids, water, digital networks, ports, airports and toll roads, and healthcare facilities (owners); grid equipment and semiconductors (suppliers). The largest kinds today are digital networks 25%, healthcare facilities 22% and power 19%. The Philippines is held through ICTSI (4.8%), on the same tests as everyone else.

How we choose: four published steps

Map the largest listed companies in each kind (140); **check the fit** on revenue and cash flow (129); **verify the merit** with an industry-sized debt stress test and value and quality against peers (49 eligible); **position the risk** so each holding adds a similar share of risk, within limits of 20% per company and 25% per kind of capacity (31 held). Details on page 3.

What could go wrong

It is an equity fund: in a bad year it can fall sharply (the industry-level history’s worst 12 months lost 27%). About 92% is in foreign currencies, unhedged, so a stronger peso lowers returns. Digital networks sit at the 25% cap and data-centre spending drives about 11%. That is why the fund is only for goals at least five years away, and why the goal service exists for the last stretch.

What the evidence says, honestly

Over five years in pesos, today’s 31 holdings returned **25.0% a year** after all costs, against **10.0%** for the benchmark (NFRA global infrastructure ETF), with a worst fall of –7.4%. This includes hindsight, because the companies were picked in 2026. Two checks keep it honest: without the chip and grid-equipment makers the rest still returned **18.7%**; and an industry-level version of the strategy returned **12.0% a year from 1990 to 2026**, about the world market, with a worst 12 months of –27%. That is the right expectation: market-like growth from businesses people cannot do without.

The customer journey

1 • Discover	A 30-second ad and social content ask one question: what is your next first?
2 • Set a first	Calculator: the goal, the amount, the year (at least 5 years away) → a monthly amount.
3 • Start	Suitability check, then ₱100 or more, once or monthly, in the BPI app.
4 • Stay on track	Progress against the goal; optional glidepath as the date nears (proposed).
5 • Reach it	Withdraw any business day (paid T+5), then set the next first.

Why it fits BPI Wealth

It adds a direct global equity fund with one fee and a ₱100 entry to a shelf where global equity mostly comes through feeder funds, and it gives young clients a goal-based reason to start early and stay. It works within existing rules: a UITF with daily NAVPU, the BSP 20% single-company ceiling, and standard suitability checks.

Proposed, not existing. Firsts Fund, its ₱100 minimum, 1.50% fee, settlement terms and the goal service are proposals for FinQuest 2026. Past results shown are for today’s holdings and include hindsight; they are not a forecast. Pages 2 and 3 are the fund fact sheet.

FIRSTS FUND

FUND FACT SHEET · PROPOSED ACTIVELY MANAGED GLOBAL EQUITY UITF

A FinQuest 2026 proposal, not an existing BPI product · Portfolio as of 2 October 2026 · Page 2 of 3

"Fund your firsts."

FUND OBJECTIVE AND THEME

Objective. Long-term capital growth by investing directly in listed companies around the world that own, operate or supply essential, hard-to-replace capacity: power and water systems, digital networks, ports, airports, hospitals, and the equipment they run on.

How the fund invests, in one line. We identify businesses providing essential capacity, check their financial strength and value, and build a portfolio that balances opportunities with risk. How many companies we hold follows from that process. The fund is **actively managed with diversification and risk controls**; the manager may change holdings and weights within the mandate.

Why it exists. An early-career Filipino earns and saves in pesos, so their future depends on one economy. Firsts Fund would let them own a share of essential businesses around the world from ₱100, in pesos, through a fund that holds the shares directly with a single fee.

Suitable investor. Regular income, a goal at least **five years** away, and the risk tolerance for an equity fund that can fall sharply in a bad year. Not suitable for money needed within five years or for emergency savings.

Separate goal service (proposed platform feature). An authorized account-level glidepath would gradually move part of an investor's Firsts Fund units into a lower-risk fund as their chosen goal approaches, with the investor's permission. It changes only that investor's mix, not how this fund invests. Units are sold at the price of the day, at a gain or a loss, and the goal amount is not guaranteed.

For a regular saver (illustration, not a forecast). ₱1,000 a month for 5 years is ₱60,000 paid in. Across every 5-year stretch from 1990 to 2026 in the industry-level history (381 start months), the typical saver ended with about **₱80,000**. About 1 in 9 stretches ended below ₱60,000; the worst, ending in early 2009, at about ₱39,000. With the proposed glidepath, the worst was about ₱52,000.

Same fee and costs; contributions at the start of each month. It reflects the theme, not our company choices.

KEY FACTS

Structure	Global equity UITF (proposed)
Currency	Philippine peso; daily NAVPU
Horizon	5 years or longer
Risk classification	Aggressive
Minimum (proposed)	₱100 to start and per top-up
Fee (proposed)	1.50% a year
All-in cost (est.)	about 2.1% a year, all costs
Buy or sell (proposed)	Any business day; paid T+5; no exit fee
Holdings	31 listed companies, 14 markets
Cash	About 3%, kept to pay redemptions
Limit per company	20% (BSP rule); largest today 5.8%
Benchmark	NFRA global infrastructure ETF, in pesos
Trustee	BPI Wealth (proposed)

ALLOCATION BY KIND OF CAPACITY

Digital networks	25.00%
Healthcare facilities	22.19%
Power generation & grids	19.22%
Ports	10.04%
Semiconductors	8.13%
Water	7.68%
Grid & power equipment	2.76%
Airports & toll roads	1.98%
Operating cash	3.00%

By listing market

United States	22.96%
Hong Kong / China	10.98%
Saudi Arabia	10.91%
Germany	8.44%
Thailand	7.28%
Japan	5.56%
Malaysia	5.23%
Philippines	4.80%
6 other markets	20.84%

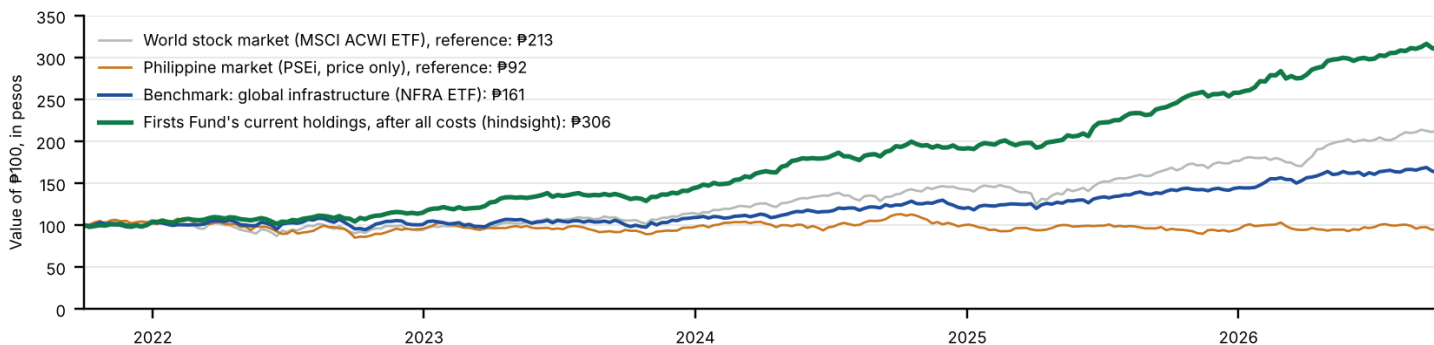
Largest holdings. Exelon 5.8%, Westports 5.2%, ICTSI 4.8%, Engie 4.6%, Bangkok Dusit Medical 4.5%. No company is above 5.8%; all 31 are listed on page 3.

No country quota. Philippine-listed ICTSI is held at 4.80% because it passed the same tests as every other company. Where a company is listed is not always where it earns its revenue.

Shared drivers. About 11% depends on data-centre spending (chips and grid equipment). Digital networks are at the fund's 25% cap per kind of capacity.

PERFORMANCE VS BENCHMARK · PAST RETURNS OF TODAY'S HOLDINGS, IN PESOS · NOT ACTUAL FUND PERFORMANCE

₱100 invested in October 2021 → ₱306 for today's holdings after all costs, vs **₱161** for the benchmark: **25.0% vs 10.0%** a year. **Hindsight:** these companies were chosen in October 2026, so this is not a forecast.



In pesos	2021*	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026*	A year	Volatility	Worst fall
Firsts Fund holdings, after costs	+3.8%	+10.6%	+25.4%	+32.9%	+34.9%	+18.5%	+25.0%	10.2%	−7.4%
Benchmark: NFRA infrastructure ETF	+3.1%	−2.4%	+8.3%	+10.2%	+19.8%	+12.2%	+10.0%	12.4%	−12.6%
World market (MSCI ACWI ETF)	+6.3%	−11.4%	+21.5%	+24.7%	+23.7%	+20.2%	+16.2%	14.8%	−18.2%
Philippine market (PSEi, price only)	+2.7%	−6.8%	+1.7%	+2.8%	−6.3%	−2.0%	−1.7%	13.7%	−21.1%

How to read this. These are past returns of the 31 companies we hold today, after the 1.50% fee, trading costs and dividend taxes; because they were picked knowing how they did, the fund's real results would likely be lower. **Without the 7 chip and grid-equipment companies**, the other 24 returned 18.7% a year (₱100 → ₱237), so the lead over the benchmark does not rest on them alone. **Over the long run:** an industry-level version of the strategy returned 12.0% a year from 1990 to 2026, about the same as the world market (12.2%), with a worst 12 months of −27%. Benchmark and references are ETFs after their own fees. *2021 from 1 Oct; 2026 to 2 Oct.

IMPORTANT. Firsts Fund is a student competition proposal; no such fund exists and nothing here is an offer, solicitation or investment advice. Simulated and historical figures do not represent actual trading. The value of units can fall as well as rise and an investor may get back less than invested. A UITF is not a deposit and is not insured by PDIC.

ALL 31 HOLDINGS · WEIGHTED SO EACH COMPANY ADDS A SIMILAR SHARE OF RISK · AS OF 2 OCTOBER 2026

Holding	Capacity	Weight	Holding	Capacity	Weight
Exelon	US Power & grids	5.81%	Enel	IT Power & grids	2.98%
Westports	MY Ports	5.23%	Saudi Telecom	SA Digital networks	2.97%
ICTSI	PH Ports	4.80%	Bharti Airtel	IN Digital networks	2.97%
Engie	FR Power & grids	4.57%	Deutsche Telekom	DE Digital networks	2.85%
Bangkok Dusit Medical	TH Healthcare facilities	4.49%	Bumrungrad Hospital	TH Healthcare facilities	2.79%
E.ON	DE Power & grids	4.48%	Qualcomm	US Semiconductors	2.27%
Dr. Sulaiman Al Habib	SA Healthcare facilities	4.41%	América Móvil	MX Digital networks	2.01%
Guangdong Investment	HK Water	4.36%	OMA (airports)	MX Airports & toll roads	1.98%
KDDI	JP Digital networks	3.81%	Advantest	JP Semiconductors	1.74%
Encompass Health	US Healthcare facilities	3.78%	HD Hyundai Electric	KR Grid & power equipment	1.65%
AT&T	US Digital networks	3.77%	NVIDIA	US Semiconductors	1.64%
Mouwasat Medical Services	SA Healthcare facilities	3.52%	Vistra	US Power & grids	1.38%
China Telecom	HK Digital networks	3.33%	SK hynix	KR Semiconductors	1.37%
Sabesp	BR Water	3.31%	Micron	US Semiconductors	1.12%
China Mobile	HK Digital networks	3.29%	Siemens Energy	DE Grid & power equipment	1.11%
HCA Healthcare	US Healthcare facilities	3.19%			

Weights move as prices change and are reviewed quarterly and when material events affect a holding. Watchlisted and rejected companies, with reasons, and the full investment assessment for each holding are in the supporting proposal.

HOW WE BUILD THE PORTFOLIO · 140 COMPANIES SCREENED → 31 HELD · SAME PUBLISHED RULES FOR EVERY COMPANY



Judgement sits in the published rules, not in picking favourites: a quarterly review may remove a holding for a material event (and logs why), but never resizes one by hand. Thresholds and every company's result are in the supporting proposal.

KEY RISKS	
Market	Share prices can fall sharply. In 36 years of industry-level history the worst 12 months lost 27% and the deepest fall was 44%.
Concentration	Digital networks are at the fund's 25% cap; data-centre spending drives about 11% of the fund but more of its past return (memory-chip makers are near a cyclical peak); Saudi Arabia 11% and US health policy about 7%.
Currency	About 92% is in foreign currencies and not hedged; a stronger peso lowers returns in pesos.
Liquidity	Some shares trade less often. Each holding is kept small enough to sell within a week without moving its price much (sized for a P1bn fund), and about 3% is kept in cash to pay redemptions.
Country and regulation	Companies in emerging markets, including some partly owned by governments, face policy and sanctions risk.
Selection	Companies are screened with one data provider and thresholds set by the team; the past results shown include hindsight.

FEES AND CHARGES	
Management fee (proposed)	1.50% a year of fund value, accrued daily
Trading costs (modelled)	about 0.21% a year
Dividend withholding (modelled)	about 0.37% a year
Subscription / redemption fee	None proposed
Minimum holding period	None proposed; 5 years+ is a recommendation
Estimated all-in cost	about 2.1% a year

SUBSCRIPTIONS AND REDEMPTIONS (PROPOSED)

Buy units with a one-time amount, a regular monthly plan, or top-ups whenever you like. Sell on any business day at that day's price per unit (NAVPU); the money is paid on day 6, end of day, in line with BPI's peso global equity funds. A missed monthly contribution does not change your goal date and is not taken automatically later.

COMPARED WITH TODAY'S CHOICES		
Product	Structure	Min.
BPI Global Equity Fund-of-Funds (peso class)	Two fee layers	P1,000
BPI Philippine Equity Index Fund	One economy	P1,000
Pag-IBIG MP2	Savings; better under 5 years	P500
Firsts Fund (proposed)	Direct global shares, one fee	P100

Sources. Company data: stockanalysis.com (S&P Global Market Intelligence), 8 Oct 2026. Prices: Yahoo Finance total returns and PSE Edge (with cash dividends), converted to pesos weekly. Benchmark: FlexShares STOXX Global Broad Infrastructure Index Fund (NFRA), Yahoo Finance adjusted close in pesos; cross-check iShares Global Infrastructure ETF (IGF) returned 13.7% a year. Cash: BSP policy rate minus 0.50 pt. Industry-level history: Kenneth French Data Library and BIS exchange rates. Single-company limit: BSP Circular No. 1234, Series of 2026 (20 May 2026), a 20% ceiling, not a target. Comparison funds: BPI Wealth fund pages and Pag-IBIG. Industry classifications assigned by the team. Dividend tax rates approximate, to be confirmed.

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